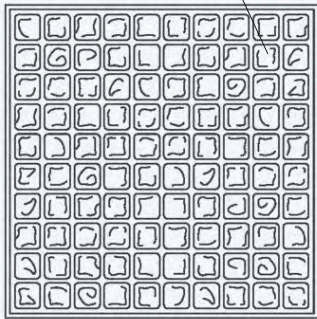


MATERIALS AND DETAILS

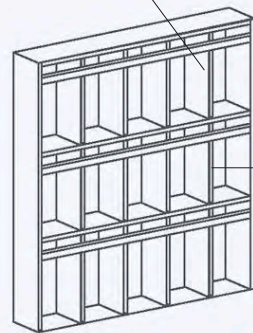
bricks typically form a wall of square blocks



△ GLASS BRICKS

Glass bricks are a common feature in Modernist buildings. They allow for a literal wall of glass, while their semiopaqueness ensures some privacy for the building's interior.

horizontal and vertical fins create shade

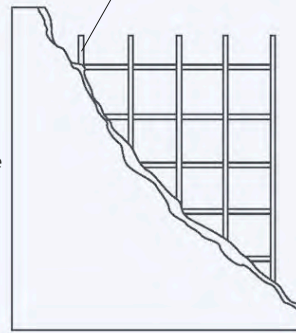


fins made from concrete

△ BRISE-SOLEIL

Meaning "sun blocker," a brise-soleil is a structure attached to the face of a building, intended to block direct sunlight—important when a facade contains large expanses of glass.

rebars (reinforcing bars) help resist tensile stress



△ REINFORCED CONCRETE

A composite material of concrete and steel reinforcement bars, reinforced concrete remains strong under both compression and tension, making it a vital modern building material.

▼ VILLA SAVOYE

Villa Savoye embodies Le Corbusier's Five Points. Supporting walls are replaced by pilotis (point 1). This allows for complete freedom in the internal plan (2), a correspondingly free facade (3), ribbon windows to maximize natural light (4), and a roof garden (5).

curvilinear forms on roof echo curved glass of ground-floor entrance

Architectural styles

MODERNISM

Modernism embraced the use of new building materials and technologies to forge an architecture that reflected the new spirit of the 20th century. Rejecting decoration in favor of abstraction, Modernism transformed cities across the world.

By the beginning of the 20th century, a number of architects began to argue that architecture as it was currently practiced had reached the end of the road. While the industrial revolution had transformed almost every aspect of everyday life, architecture had continued to look to increasingly anachronistic historic styles. Modernism emerged as a concerted attempt to forge an architecture that would not only reflect industry's transformations but also harness them toward positive and progressive ends.

One of the most influential architects attempting to articulate this new direction was the Swiss-French Charles-Édouard Jeanneret, better known as Le Corbusier. He famously outlined Five Points of a New Architecture, which would help show the way forward structurally and aesthetically. In effect, Le Corbusier advocated that form should follow function, that the appearance and layout of a building should be determined by its intended use. Ornament and decoration were replaced with a fresh, clean, and supposedly rational aesthetic.

Modernist principles proved influential all over the world, notably in the rebuilding effort after World War II. While Modernism's legacy has been profound, it has also been highly contested, especially when it was aligned with particular political ideals.

roof garden and solarium provide additional outdoor leisure space

facade has clean, uncluttered lines

walls are lightweight rather than load-bearing

curved outer wall of ground level designed with turning radius of a car in mind

long, horizontal windows, known as ribbon windows, for illumination and ventilation

◁ CURVED GLASS

Many Modernist architects placed huge importance on the amount of natural light entering buildings, with large curved or ribbon windows a common feature across a range of building types.